

UNIT ONE

Reconstruction

The Promise and Peril of Rebuilding a Nation

— 1865–1877

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

How should a nation rebuild after civil war — and who is included in, or excluded from, the new order it creates?

STANDARDS**US.REC · US.01–US.07****PRIMARY PRACTICE****SSP.05 · Historical Awareness****PACING**

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UNIT TWO

The Gilded Age

Progress, Poverty, and the Price of Growth

— 1870–1900

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

Who benefited from America's industrial revolution, and at whose expense did that prosperity come?

STANDARDS
US.08–US.18

PRIMARY PRACTICE
SSP.06 · Geographic Awareness

PACING
18 days

UNIT THREE

Progressive Era & Imperialism

Reform and Empire

— 1890–1920

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

Can government fix the problems created by industrial capitalism — and what does the reach for empire reveal about America's values?

STANDARDS
US.19–US.27**PRIMARY PRACTICE**
SSP.04 · Argue with Evidence**PACING**
18 days

UNIT FOUR

WWI & the Roaring Twenties

War, Prosperity, and the Search for American Identity

— 1914–1929

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

How do war and cultural upheaval reshape national identity, and who gets to define what it means to be American?

STANDARDS
US.28–US.38**PRIMARY PRACTICE**
SSP.03 · Synthesize Data**PACING**
18 days

UNIT FIVE

The Great Depression & New Deal

Crisis and Response

— 1929–1941

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

When the free market catastrophically fails, what obligations does the government have to its citizens?

STANDARDS
US.39–US.44

PRIMARY PRACTICE
SSP.04 · Argue with Evidence

PACING
16 days

UNIT SIX

World War II

Democracy at War

— 1939–1945

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

What sacrifices are citizens of a democracy obligated to make in defense of their freedoms — and where is the limit?

STANDARDS
US.45–US.58**PRIMARY PRACTICE**
SSP.02 · Examine Sources**PACING**
18 days

UNIT SEVEN

The Cold War

Containment, Conformity, and the Fight for Freedom

— 1945–1968

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

How do nations and individuals respond when the values they publicly claim to uphold conflict with their actions?

STANDARDS
US.71–US.77**PRIMARY PRACTICE**
SSP.05 · Historical Awareness**PACING**
22 days

UNIT EIGHT

Vietnam, Watergate & the 1970s

Fractures in American Democracy

— 1965–1980

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

What happens to a democracy when its citizens lose faith in their government, and what does it take to rebuild trust?

STANDARDS
US.59–US.70**PRIMARY PRACTICE**
SSP.03 · Synthesize Data**PACING**
16 days

UNIT NINE

The Conservative Revolution

Morning in America: Reagan and the End of the Cold War

— 1980–2001

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

What are the virtues and the limits of limited government, free markets, and individual responsibility?

STANDARDS
US.78–US.82

PRIMARY PRACTICE
SSP.04 · Argue with Evidence

PACING
16 days

UNIT TEN

America in the 21st Century

Unfinished Business

— 2001–PRESENT

**ESSENTIAL QUESTION**

What does it mean to be a citizen of a democracy in an age of terror, digital information, and global interdependence?

STANDARDS
US.83–US.95**PRIMARY PRACTICE**
SSP.04 · Argue with Evidence**PACING**
14 days